

Series Title: Why Worry?

Dates: November 2 - 23

Vision For The Event

"I have this theory that people possess a certain capacity for worry, no more, no less. It's as though a person has a little psychic box that he feels compelled to keep filled with worries. When one worry disappears from the box, he immediately replaces it with another worry, so the box is always full. He is never short of worries. If a new crop of worries comes in, the person sorts through the box for lesser worries and kicks them out, until he has enough room for the new worries. The lesser worries just lie around on the floor, until there's room in the box for them again, and then they're put back in. They're welcomed by the worries that have been in the box all the time: "Hi, guys! Good to have you back. Boy, you should have seen the duds that just left. And they had the nerve to call themselves worries!" - Patrick McManus

"Jesus gives us five things not to worry about in the Sermon on the Mount: fashion, finances, future, family, and food. And yet - after 2000 years, we still have all those worries hanging around " - Vanessa Reyner

In these sermons on worry, we want to take extra care not to create shame, guilt or additional worry for those with clinical anxieties. It is probably more helpful to talk about "worries" as a noun, rather than condemning "worrying" as a verb.

Because of the "practical wisdom part," this series lends itself to more practical advice in addition to theological exposition.

The Goals of the Series

- Help the congregation name and address their specific worries in light of biblical teaching.
- Provide practical, research-backed wisdom for managing worry in a Christ-centered way.
- Encourage trust in God's provision and care as an antidote to worry.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
11/2/25	Fashion	Matthew 6:28-32
11/9/25	Future	Matthew 6:27
11/16/25	Family	Matthew 5:27-32, 7:9-12
11/23/25	Food	Matthew 6:25-26

Synopses

Week 1 | Fashion | Matthew 6:28-32

This sermon on Fashion, rooted in Matthew 6:28-32, uses Jesus’ invitation to “consider the lilies” as a lens to explore our relationship with clothing and appearances. It begins with the humorous concept of the “worry box,” illustrating how we fill our minds with concerns that dominate our thoughts. The message connects Jesus’ words to the historical realities of the first-century audience, for whom clothing was a vital and labor-intensive possession. Jesus wasn’t dismissing the significance of clothing but instead calling His followers to reframe their concerns within the context of God’s abundant provision and beauty.

The sermon invites listeners to reimagine their relationship with worries by aligning their priorities with God’s kingdom. Practical insights are woven throughout, emphasizing the importance of seeking God’s purpose as the primary "story" that frames our lives. By doing so, the worries of fashion—or any other distractions—find less room to dominate. The overarching message is one of hope: that trust in God’s care leads to freedom from anxiety and a fuller appreciation of life’s blessings, including the beauty and creativity reflected in something as simple as clothing.

Week 2 | Future | Matthew 6:27

This sermon on The Future, based on Matthew 6:27, explores Jesus' profound question: "Can any one of you by worrying add a single hour to your life?" The message acknowledges how deeply future-oriented worries dominate our thoughts, often overshadowing the present. By emphasizing that God has already secured the ultimate future—His eternal victory—the sermon challenges the congregation to trust in God's promises and let go of their fears. The inevitability of God's kingdom reframes the narrative of worry, shifting the focus from uncertainty to the assurance that God's plan is unshakable and good.

Practical wisdom is interwoven throughout the sermon, offering actionable ways to address future-related anxieties. Suggestions include practicing gratitude for the present, engaging in prayerful connection with God and others, and reimagining worries in the light of God's ultimate victory. These steps guide the congregation toward replacing fear with faith, inviting them to live as though God's future has already begun—a future where God's grace, mercy, and eternal reign overshadow all earthly concerns.

Week 3 | Family | Matthew 5:27-32, 7:9-12

Worries about family often carry deep emotional weight. Jesus's teaching on marriage, family, and relationships provides a framework for understanding God's priorities for love and care within these bonds. This sermon will discuss how to navigate relational challenges with grace, offering advice on healthy boundaries, forgiveness, and building family dynamics on a foundation of God's love and wisdom.

Week 4 | Food | Matthew 6:25-26

This sermon on Food, based on Matthew 6:25-26, invites the congregation to reflect on the shift from historical worries about survival to modern concerns about abundance, nutrition, and choice. Jesus' teaching to "look at the birds of the air" is presented not as a dismissal of food's importance but as an invitation to replace worry with trust in God's provision. The sermon emphasizes how trust—baked into the systems that ensure our access to food—is the antidote to worry. It reframes the narrative: in God's kingdom, the opposite of worry is not control but faith-filled trust.

Through historical context and practical examples, the message illustrates how trusting God can transform anxieties into opportunities to see His abundance. It culminates in the connection between trust and the sacrament of communion, highlighting how coming to God's table is a communal act of faith. This act demonstrates that God provides more than enough, inviting participants to live not out of scarcity but from the overflow of God's grace. The sermon closes with a hopeful challenge: to trust in God so completely that worry finds no room in our lives.